

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 121

By Maberry

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Sarah Lee Best.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the untimely death of Sarah Lee Best; and

WHEREAS, a native of Clarksville, Ms. Best was an attorney with Wilkinson Stekloff Law Firm in Washington, D.C.; and

WHEREAS, a gifted and dedicated student, Sarah Best graduated *summa cum laude* with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Neuroscience and Classical Languages from Vanderbilt University in 2013; and

WHEREAS, she then taught high school math and worked as an instructional coach in her native Tennessee before entering law school; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Best graduated *summa cum laude* from the University of Pennsylvania Law School, where her former professors praise her as a brilliant student and a beloved member of the school's community; and

WHEREAS, during her tenure in law school, Sarah Best was a senior editor of the *University of Pennsylvania Law Review*, served on the board of Penn's Asian Pacific American Law Student Association, interned for the U.S. Department of Education's Office of the General Counsel, completed an externship with the Education Law Center, and worked in the Transnational Legal Clinic, where she represented clients seeking asylum; and

WHEREAS, she also was inducted into the Order of the Coif, received the David Werner Amram Prize and the Exceptional Pro Bono Service Award, and was named the Edwin R. Keedy Cup Moot Court Winner and Best Oralist; and

WHEREAS, through her school's Federal Appellate Litigation Externship, Ms. Best argued a case before the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Third Circuit in which the district court's judgment was vacated, resulting in a positive result for her client; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Best will be fondly remembered as "a brilliant, kind, and compassionate soul who touched the lives of so many," and her memory will be treasured by the loved ones and colleagues she has left behind; and

WHEREAS, Sarah Best brought light into many lives during her all-too-brief time on earth, and her passing gives credence to the adage that only the best are taken from us at an early age; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Sarah Lee Best, reflecting upon her legacy of acumen as an attorney, dedication as a scholar, and excellence as a human being.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Ms. Best's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.